

# Open Source Productivity Tools that Run on Windows

Productivity tools are software programs that allow a computer user to do certain specific tasks quickly and efficiently. The productivity tools listed here are open source and specifically meant for the Windows operating system.



**T**he personal computer has become a part of most professionals' lives, irrespective of the arena in which they work. Even a small shopkeeper uses a PC to maintain the records of his daily sales and purchases. Today, we are all pretty dependent on computers, and their efficiency and productivity directly impacts our personal productivity. If we spend around three hours a day to do a set of tasks, a quick and productive computer system may help us finish the same tasks in, maybe, around two-and-a-half hours. More than 86 per cent of the computers used in our homes and offices run on some form of the Windows OS. Hence, the productivity of Windows' computer systems is really important.

There has been an enormous increase in the amount of data that our computer needs to process on a daily basis. For instance, a computer at a shopping centre needs to add and maintain the records of numerous customers who make daily purchases along with the list of items purchased by them, their prices and offers, etc. All this adds up to gigabytes of data, which impacts the performance of the computer when it computes large data sets. The productivity of Windows systems also depends upon factors like the frequency with which the different system files are cleaned, the way the large log files or a file system are handled, drive space utilisation, etc.

Thankfully, there are many open source tools running on Windows that can increase a system's productivity. These are available free of cost and can be easily tried out by anyone. Also, there is enough documentation and many write-ups available for these open source tools, which makes it much easier to use them. It is also easier to modify them as per our requirements since, being open source, their source code is easily accessible.

## The need for open source productivity tools

I feel productivity tools should be named facilitation tools. Also, these tools offer a lot more than what we discussed. Let's check out why they are in such great demand.

1. Productivity tools are in high demand as they help users to perform any specific task with much ease and flexibility, in less time. They are quite user-friendly.
2. Open source productivity tools are available free of cost and do not carry any pricing overheads, which is one of the main reasons why these tools are preferred.
3. Also, the developers of open source productivity tools make some or all of the source code freely available to the public. This allows others to take the code and alter it to create their own software.